others before him had tried and failed to solve, a problem for which the very path taken by him turned out to have been the best preparation. Thus, he was able to recognize and to formulate, from measurements of radiations, the law which bears and immortalizes his name for all times. He announced it before the Berlin Physical Society on October 19, 1900. To be sure, the theoretical substantiation of it made it necessary for him to reconsider his views and to fall back on methods of the atom theory, which he had been wont to regard with certain doubts, And beyond that, he had to venture a hypothesis, the audacity of which was not clear at first, to its full extent, to anybody, not even to him. But on December 14, 1900, again before the German Physical Society, he was able to present the theoretic deduction of the law of radiation. This was the birthday of the quantum theory. This achievement will perpetuate his name forever.

This is why on this day innumerable scientific bodies have expressed their sympathy and grief over his death, in telegrams, or by sending their representatives here. Thus, we have with us now the President of the Academy of Berlin, and the Rector of the University of Berlin, two bodies with which Max Planck was especially closely affiliated. He taught at the University for more than forty years, and he was a member of the Academy for more than half a century; in fact, most of that time he held the office of one of its four Permanent Secretaries. Likewise, the Academies of Munich and Göttingen are represented here by their Presidents, the University of Göttingen by its Rector, and the School of Engineering of Hannover by its Faculty delegate. Furthermore, wreaths have been placed on the bier in behalf of the State Government of Lower Saxony.

I would like to mention, in particular, some of the many wreaths lying here. One of them was sent by the German Museum in Munich, which is just about to place Max Planck’s bust in its Hall of Fame. Next to the respects paid by the Academy of Munich, this wreath is the last salute from Bavaria, where Planck grew up, and where he would spend his vacation every year, to seek and find pleasure and relaxation.

Another wreath is inscribed: “The German Physical Societies to their Honorary Member.” These Societies remember the fifty-eight years of Planck’s membership, his selfless work in the most diverse administrative posts; for the major part of his membership he was a member of the Board, and also held its chairmanship several times. They remember, in particular, the great many enlightening lectures which he delivered at their scientific meetings, and above all, that address in 1900 when, as mentioned before, he made his first disclosure of his law of radiation and its deduction. A bright ray of his brilliant fame was thus reflected on the German Physical Society, too.

And here is a plainer wreath, without any streamers. It was placed here by me in behalf of all his pupils, among whom I count myself, as a perishable